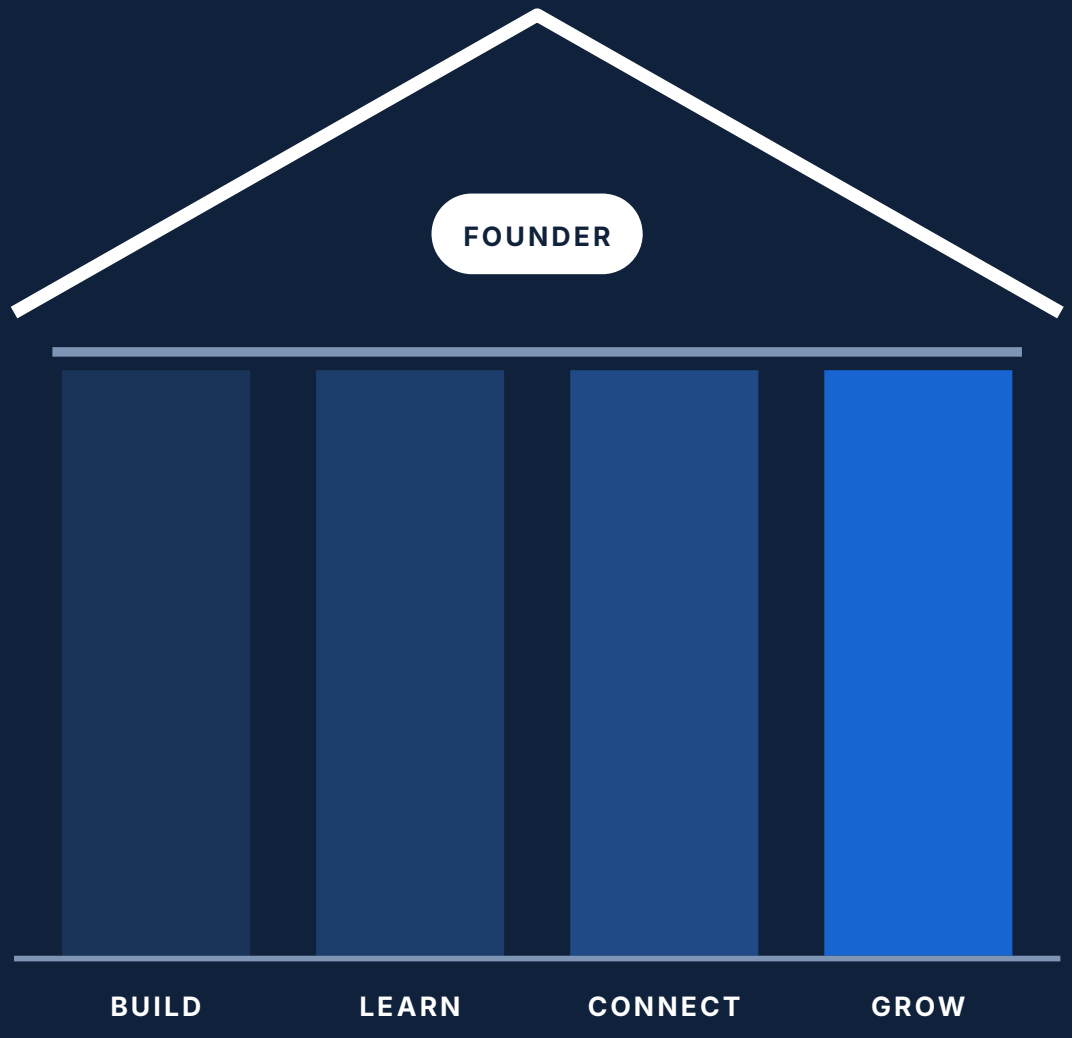
STARTUP ROOF

A FOUNDER ECOSYSTEM · UAE FIRST, GLOBAL AMBITION

STARTUP ROOF

A year-round ecosystem to help founders build, learn, connect and grow.

Home of Founder OS — the digital workspace for the founder journey.



startuproof.com

STARTUP ROOF AT A GLANCE

A practical ecosystem around the founder — on one page.

IN ONE SENTENCE

Startup Roof brings practical guidance, useful tools and meaningful connections together to help founders take their next step.

Startup Roof is the ecosystem.
Founder OS is the digital workspace inside it.

WHAT

A year-round founder ecosystem

Community, programmes, services and a guided digital workspace.

FOR WHOM

Founders first

Aspiring, early-stage and growing founders — tech and non-tech.

HOW

Build · Learn · Connect · Grow

Next steps, practical learning, relevant people and opportunities.

WHERE

UAE first, global ambition

Starting in the UAE and widening coverage over time.

STAGE

Shaping and pilot phase

Testing the founder experience with an initial group of contributors.

NEXT

A small, measured pilot

Useful sessions, onboarding and follow-up — then expand what works.

CONTENTS

What this presentation covers.

01 **Why founders need a roof**
The founder experience, why startups struggle and the UAE context

02 **The Startup Roof concept**
Ecosystem, pillars, audiences, sectors and the proposed model

03 **The founder journey**
Six stages, practical checklists, key metrics and funding options

04 **Founder OS**
The planned digital workspace, illustrative screens and principles

05 **Ecosystem services**
Community, mentoring, Academy, expert services, insights and incubation

06 **Value for the ecosystem**
Investors, universities, corporates and service partners

07 **Model, pilot and roadmap**
Commercial hypotheses, pilot design, measurement, milestones and risks

08 **People and participation**
Capabilities, contribution, FAQ, glossary and invitation

01

Why founders need a roof

The founder experience, why startups struggle and the UAE context

IN THIS CHAPTER

The founder experience today

Why startups struggle

The survival challenge

Evidence that support helps

Regional momentum and the UAE

AI in small businesses

THE FOUNDER EXPERIENCE TODAY

Founders need more than information. They need a practical path forward.

01 Information is scattered

Guidance sits across many websites, groups and programmes — hard to compare, harder to act on.

02 Tools do not connect

Plans, tasks, documents and contacts live in separate apps with no shared picture of progress.

03 Advice lacks a next step

General advice rarely translates into “what should I do this week?”

04 The right people are hard to find

Relevant mentors and specialists are often reached by chance, not by fit.

05 Introductions go nowhere

Connections are made, but few lead to a conversation with a useful outcome.

06 Time and money are limited

Founders must choose carefully where to spend scarce hours and budget.

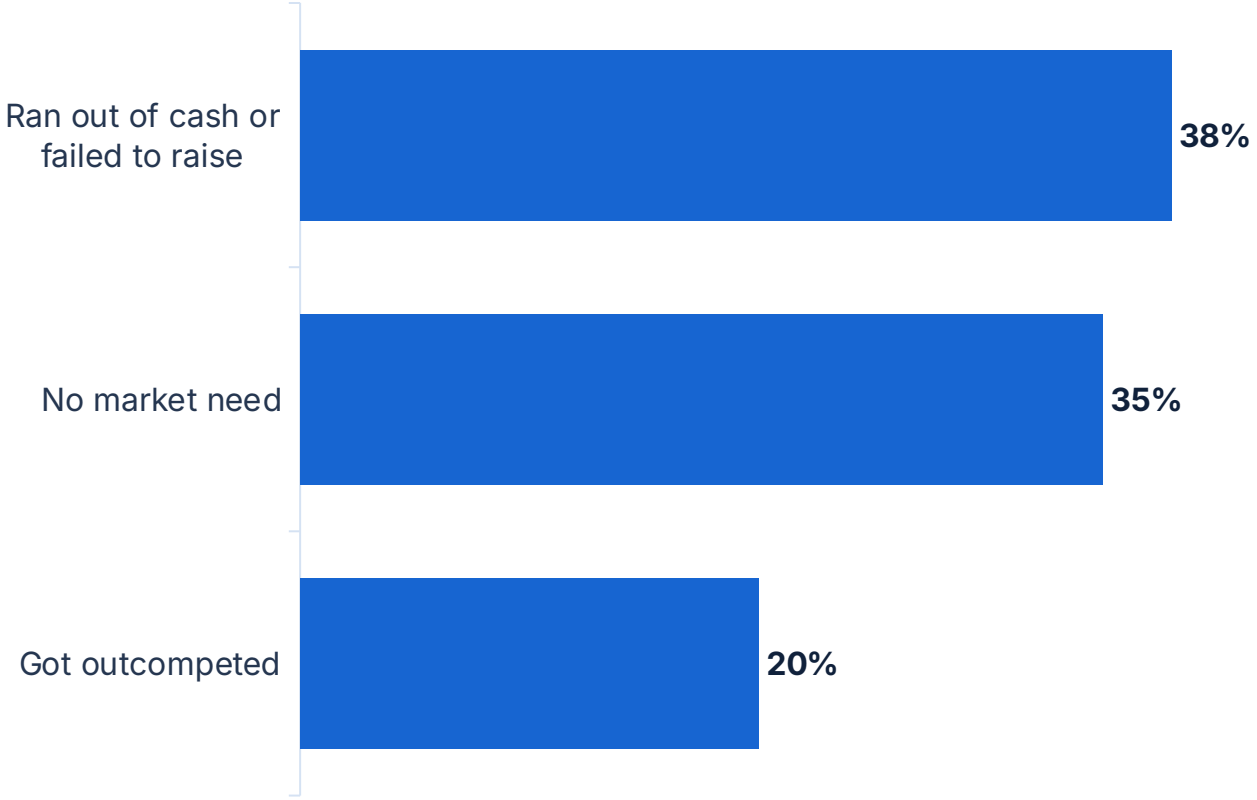
WHAT WE WILL INVESTIGATE

Our working view is that founders move faster when guidance, tools and people are connected to a clear next step.

The pilot will test this directly with founders — through interviews, sessions and follow-up — before we scale anything.

WHY STARTUPS STRUGGLE

Most failures come back to the market, cash and competition.



% of 111 startup post-mortems citing each reason (multiple reasons allowed).

Source: CB Insights, “The Top 12 Reasons Startups Fail”, 2021.

HOW STARTUP ROOF RESPONDS

Market need

Validation comes first: customer conversations and price tests before building.

Cash

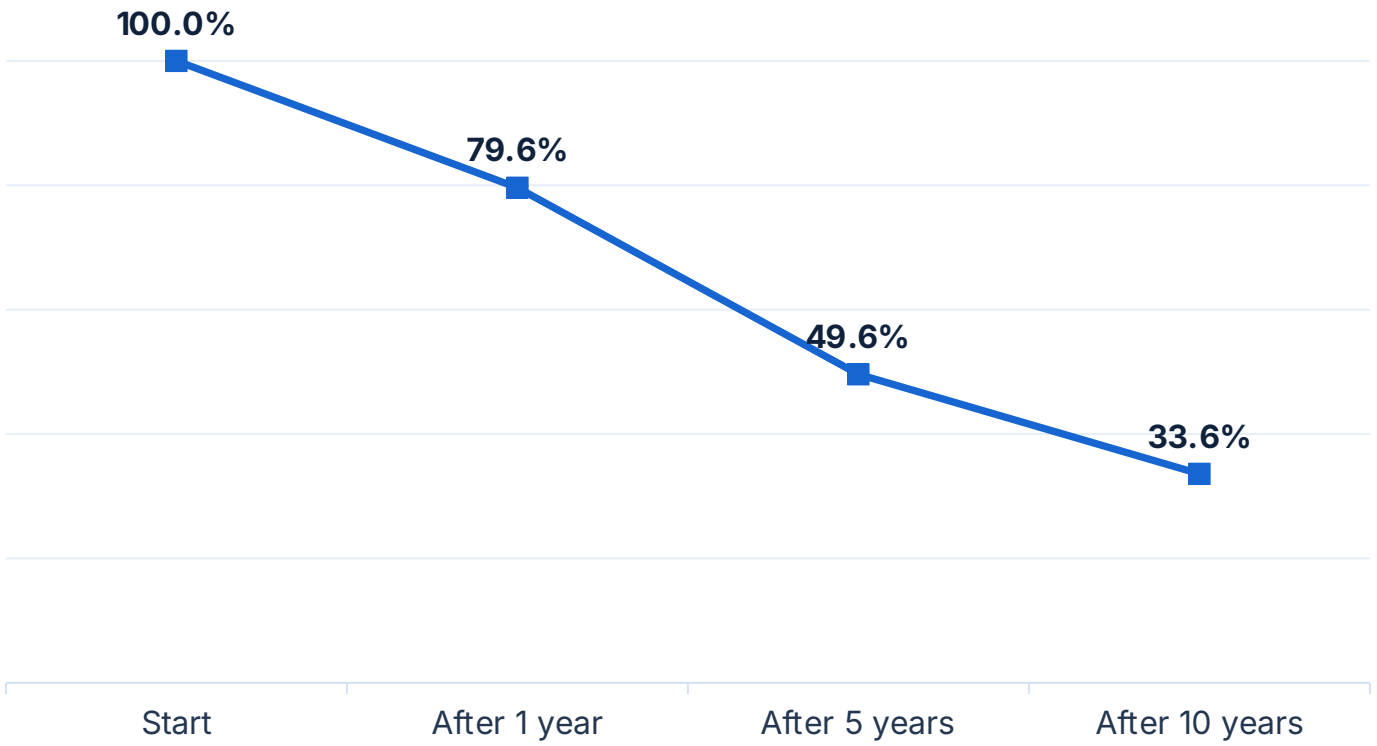
Margins, runway and funding options are taught early — not only at fundraising time.

Competition

Radar insights, sector mentors and peer groups keep founders aware of the market.

THE SURVIVAL CHALLENGE

About half of new businesses are gone within five years.



Share of US private-sector establishments opened in March 1994 that were still operating.

34.7%

of US establishments born in 2013 were still operating in 2023.

US BLS, 2024

≈ 50%

of start-ups survive five years across OECD countries studied.

OECD, 2015

1 in 2

is the simple takeaway: support in the early years matters.

Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Business Employment Dynamics (1994 cohort; TED 2024 for the 2013 cohort); Calvino, Criscuolo & Menon, OECD STI Policy Paper, 2015.

EVIDENCE THAT SUPPORT HELPS

Mentors, networks and structured programmes are linked to better outcomes.

33%

of New York tech founders mentored by successful entrepreneurs became top performers — over three times the rate of other firms.

Endeavor Insight, 2015 (study of ~700 founders)

2×

Companies connected to a top-performing company were twice as likely to become top performers themselves.

Endeavor Insight, “The Power of Entrepreneur Networks”

47–171%

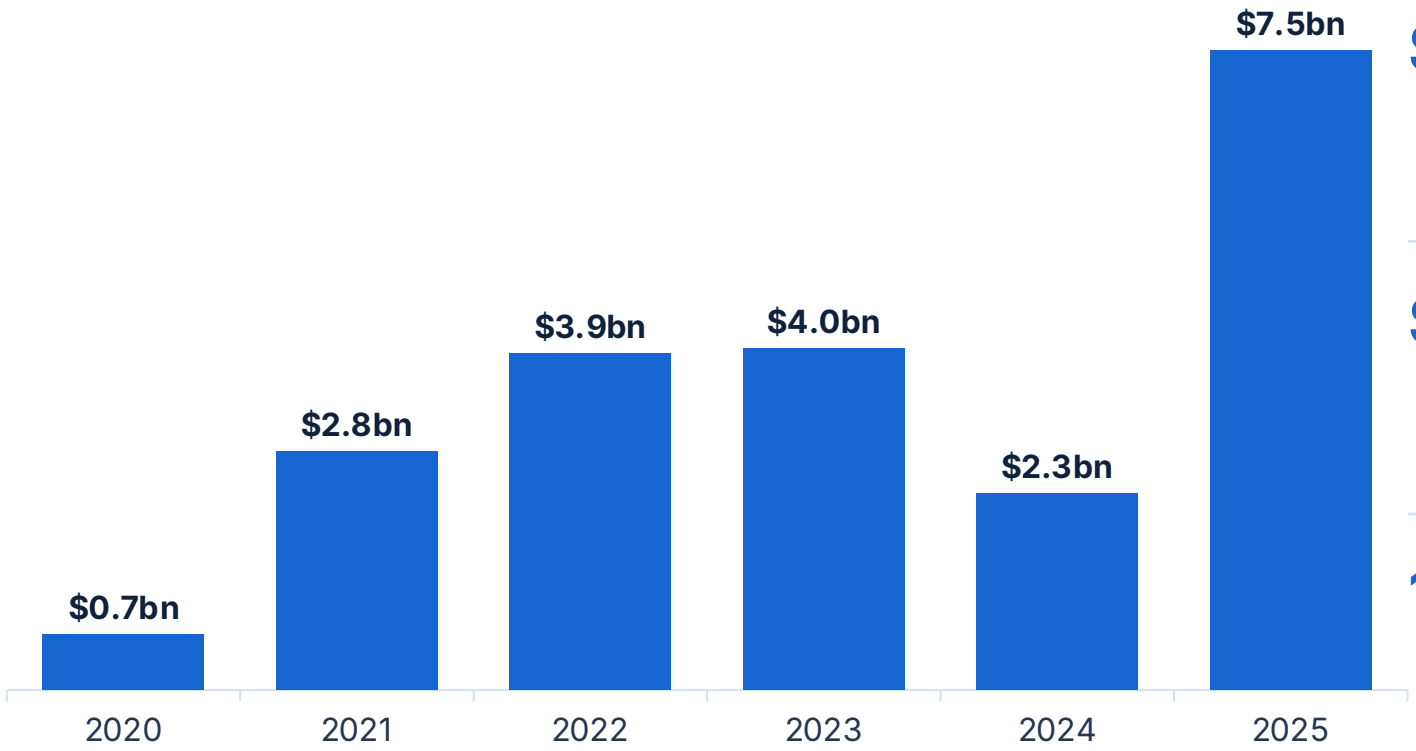
more funding raised by accelerator companies than near-miss peers in three of four cohorts studied.

Hallen, Cohen & Bingham, Organization Science, 2020

These studies show associations, not guarantees. They support Startup Roof’s design choice: combine mentoring, peer networks and structured programmes — then measure outcomes.

REGIONAL MOMENTUM

Startup funding in MENA reached a record in 2025.



Total startup funding raised in MENA, US$ billions (includes debt financing).

$7.5bn raised by 647 MENA startups in 2025 — a record year.

$1.1bn raised by UAE startups across 207 deals in 2024, ranking first in MENA that year.

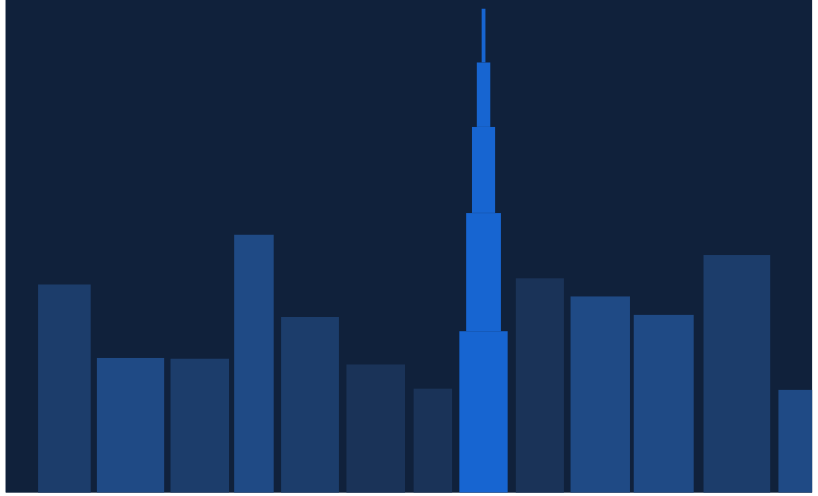
1.2% of MENA funding went to female-founded startups in 2024 — a gap worth closing.

Source: Wamda annual MENA investment reviews (2020–2025). 2023 includes $1.77bn of debt; 2021 total as reported in Wamda's 2021 review.

A national ambition to become a home for entrepreneurs.

UAE FIRST

Starting where policy, capital and founders are converging.



#1

globally in the GEM National Entrepreneurship Context Index — for the fifth consecutive year.

GEM 2025/2026

63.5%

of non-oil GDP comes from SMEs, which make up 94.4% of UAE companies.

UAE Ministry of Economy / Central Bank

557k → 1m

SMEs at end-2022, with a national target of one million by 2030.

UAE Minister of Economy, 2023

30

companies to grow into global unicorns under Dubai's D33 agenda, plus 400 high-potential firms identified.

Dubai Economic Agenda D33, 2023

20

unicorns targeted by 2031 under the national "Entrepreneurial Nation" initiative.

UAE Ministry of Economy

#19

Dubai's rank among global emerging startup ecosystems.

Startup Genome GSER 2025

High ambition, real opportunity — and a fear of failure to address.



1 in 5

adults in the UAE were starting or running a new business in 2025 — up from about one in seven in 2024.



9 in 10

adults see good opportunities to start a business, among the highest of all economies surveyed.



Over half

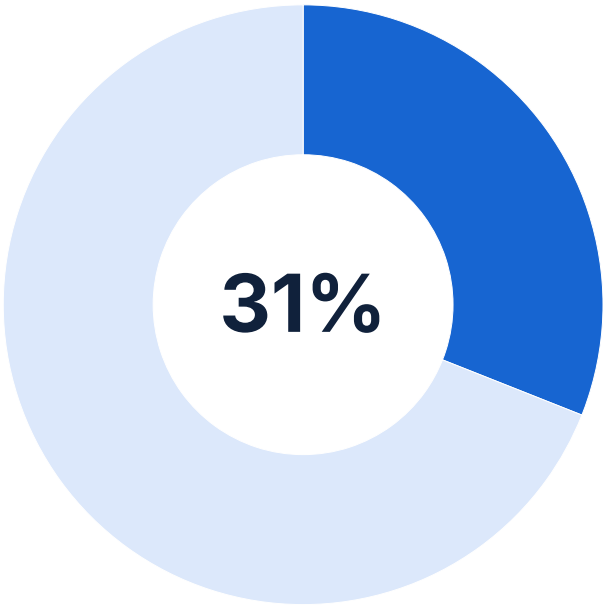
of those who see opportunities say fear of failure would stop them starting.

Practical support, peer networks and small, low-risk first steps are a direct answer to fear of failure.

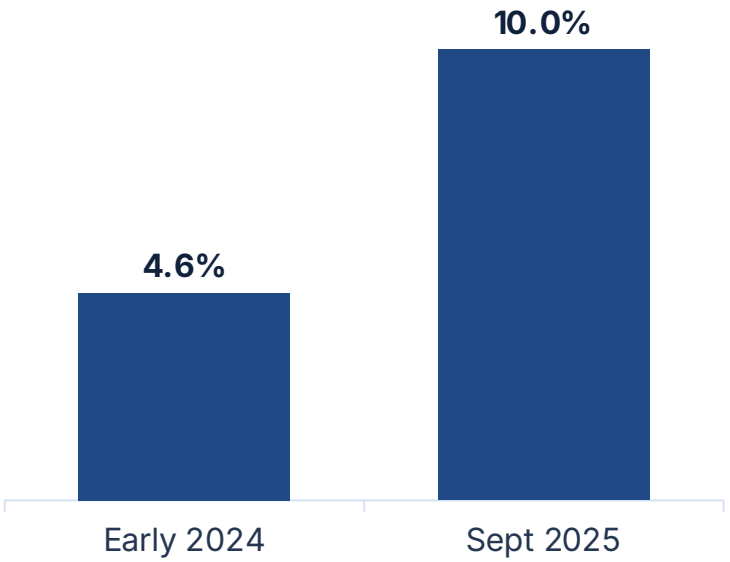
Source: Global Entrepreneurship Monitor (GEM), UAE country profile, 2025.

AI IS ARRIVING IN SMALL BUSINESSES

Founders are already using AI tools — guidance on using them well is the gap.



of SMEs surveyed in seven OECD countries use generative AI (late 2024).



of US firms used AI to produce goods or services — doubling in under two years.

WHAT THIS MEANS

AI as a founder tool, not a replacement for judgement.

Founder Academy covers practical AI and automation. Founder OS plans AI-assisted guidance — always with human support for important decisions.

Sources: OECD, "Generative AI and the SME Workforce", 2025; US Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey (2024–2025).

WHAT THIS MEANS

Support exists. Joining it up around the founder is the opportunity.

WHAT IS GROWING	WHAT FOUNDERS STILL REPORT
Startup programmes and incubators	Support is scattered and hard to compare
Venture capital and angel activity	Little continuity between programmes
Government focus on SMEs and entrepreneurship	Advice is generic, not sector-relevant
Online content, tools and AI assistants	Few introductions lead to real outcomes

STARTUP ROOF'S ROLE

Join it up.

Connect founders to the right guidance, people and opportunities at the right stage — and follow up so it leads somewhere.

Based on the project team's experience; to be tested through founder interviews in the pilot.

02

The Startup Roof concept

Ecosystem, pillars, audiences, sectors and the proposed model

IN THIS CHAPTER

What Startup Roof is

Build · Learn · Connect · Grow

Audiences and sectors

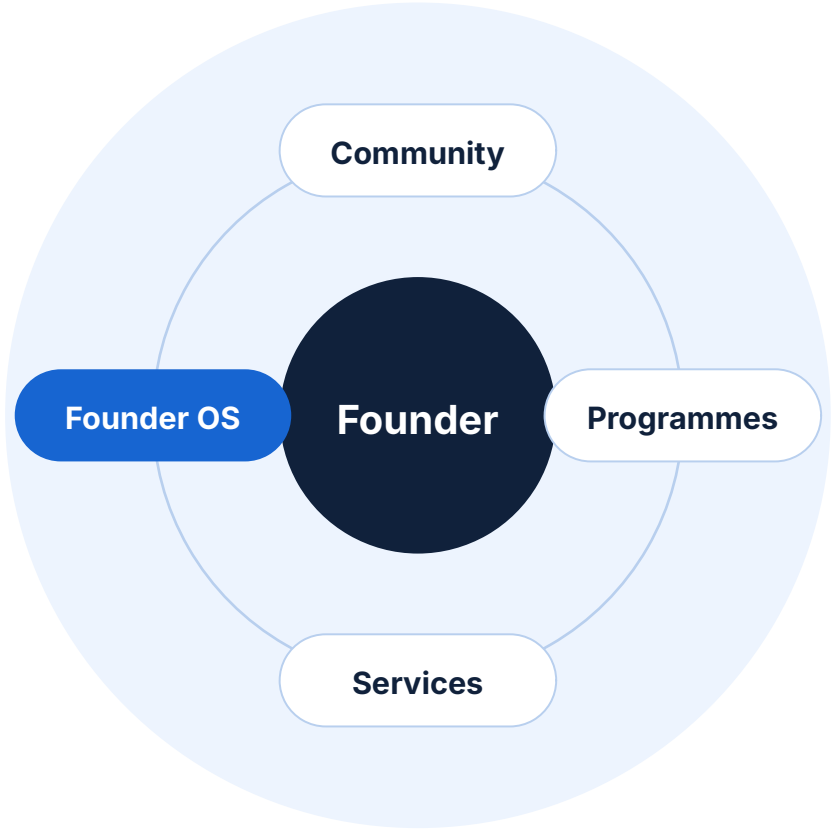
Founder personas

How value flows

The four-layer model

One ecosystem around the founder.

THE STARTUP ROOF ECOSYSTEM



STARTUP ROOF = the wider ecosystem

The community, programmes, relationships and services that surround a founder all year — online and in person.

FOUNDER OS = the digital workspace

The guided online experience inside the ecosystem: a founder's profile, goals, next steps, resources and connections in one place.

In short: an ecosystem around the founder, and a digital workspace for the journey.

BUILD · LEARN · CONNECT · GROW

Four things founders need, under one roof.



BUILD

Turn an idea into a working business.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Next-step plans, templates, product and setup guidance.

IN FOUNDER OS

Tasks and templates

LEARN

Gain practical skills, quickly.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Founder Academy sessions that end in an action.

IN FOUNDER OS

Learning progress

CONNECT

Reach the right people.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Consent-based introductions, mentors, peers and specialists.

IN FOUNDER OS

Discovery and requests

GROW

Find customers, capability and capital.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Go-to-market support, expert services, readiness and opportunities.

IN FOUNDER OS

Opportunities and progress

WHO IT IS FOR

Built for founders. Strengthened by the people around them.

PRIMARY · FOUNDERS

Aspiring entrepreneurs

Want to test an idea and understand where to start.

Early-stage founders

Need validation, structure and their first customers.

Founders seeking growth

Need operational support, specialists and sharper go-to-market.

Technology startups and commercially viable businesses in consumer, wellness, retail and services.

SUPPORTING ECOSYSTEM · WHY THEY TAKE PART

Mentors and specialists	Share experience in a structured way and meet founders who fit their expertise.
Investors and angels	Engage with better-prepared founders and follow sectors of interest.
Universities and incubators	Extend support to student and alumni founders beyond a single programme.
Corporate innovation teams	Meet early ventures and run practical challenges or pilots.
Technology and service providers	Offer relevant tools and services to founders who need them.

SECTORS WE SERVE

Not only tech. Any commercially viable business with a founder.

Technology

Software, platforms, AI-enabled products

TYPICAL CHALLENGES

- Product–market fit
- Technical choices and cost
- Recurring revenue
- Investor readiness

Consumer products

Food, beauty, home and lifestyle brands

TYPICAL CHALLENGES

- Unit economics and margin
- Manufacturing and sourcing
- Retail and e-commerce channels
- Brand building

Wellness

Fitness, nutrition, mental wellbeing, care

TYPICAL CHALLENGES

- Trust and credibility
- Licensing and compliance
- Repeat customers
- Community building

Retail

Physical and online stores, marketplaces

TYPICAL CHALLENGES

- Inventory and cash flow
- Location and channel mix
- Customer acquisition cost
- Operations at scale

Services

Agencies, consultancies, B2B and local services

TYPICAL CHALLENGES

- Pricing and packaging
- Productising expertise
- Pipeline and referrals
- Hiring and delivery

Venture funding is one route, not the goal. Many strong businesses grow from revenue — and Startup Roof is designed for them too.

FOUNDERS WE DESIGN FOR

ILLUSTRATIVE PERSONAS

Four example founders, four different next steps.



The aspiring founder

EXPLORE

SITUATION

Has an idea and a full-time job; unsure where to start.

WHAT THEY NEED

Clarity on whether the idea is worth testing.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Validation guide, peer group, first clinic.



The first-time brand owner

VALIDATE → BUILD

SITUATION

Launching a consumer product with savings.

WHAT THEY NEED

Evidence that customers will buy at a viable margin.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Pricing session, sourcing specialist, retail mentor.



The tech founder

LAUNCH

SITUATION

Has a product and early users; needs traction.

WHAT THEY NEED

A repeatable way to acquire paying customers.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

GTM sprint, customer-acquisition mentor, tool credits.



The growing service business

GROW

SITUATION

Profitable agency, stuck at founder capacity.

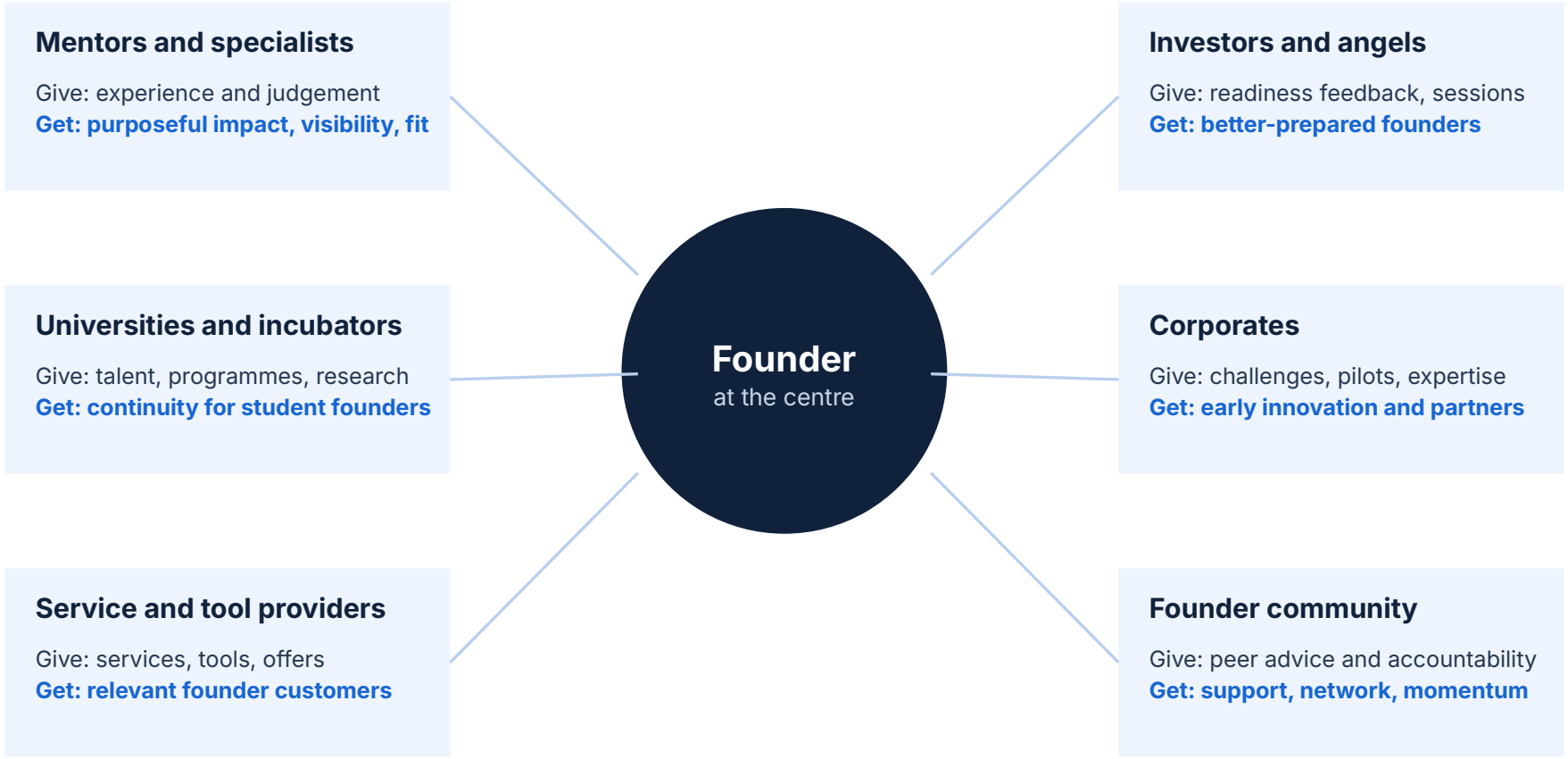
WHAT THEY NEED

Systems, hiring and productised offers.

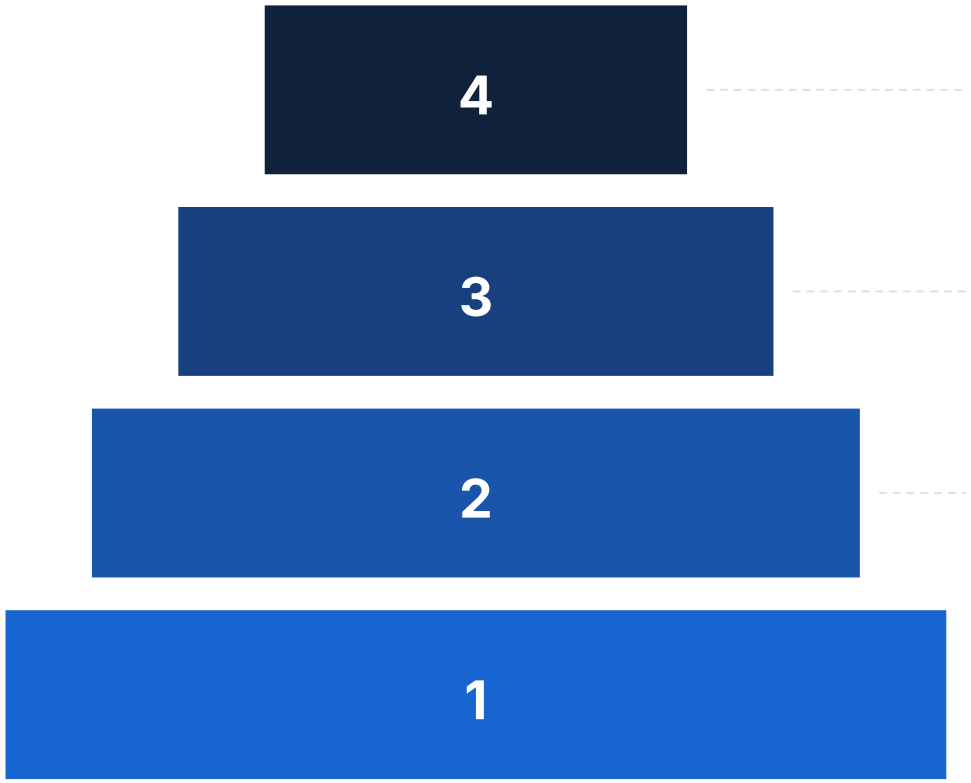
HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Operations specialist, automation, peer group.

Everyone gives something useful and gets something useful.



Four layers, from open access to selective support.



Investment connections and future pathways

Investor-readiness support and relevant introductions. Any future investment activity would need its own structure and approvals.

Selective incubation

More intensive support for suitable founders, based on fit, delivery capacity and separately agreed commercial terms.

Paid tools and support

Deeper tools, potential AI-assisted guidance, specialist sessions and structured programmes.

Free founder access

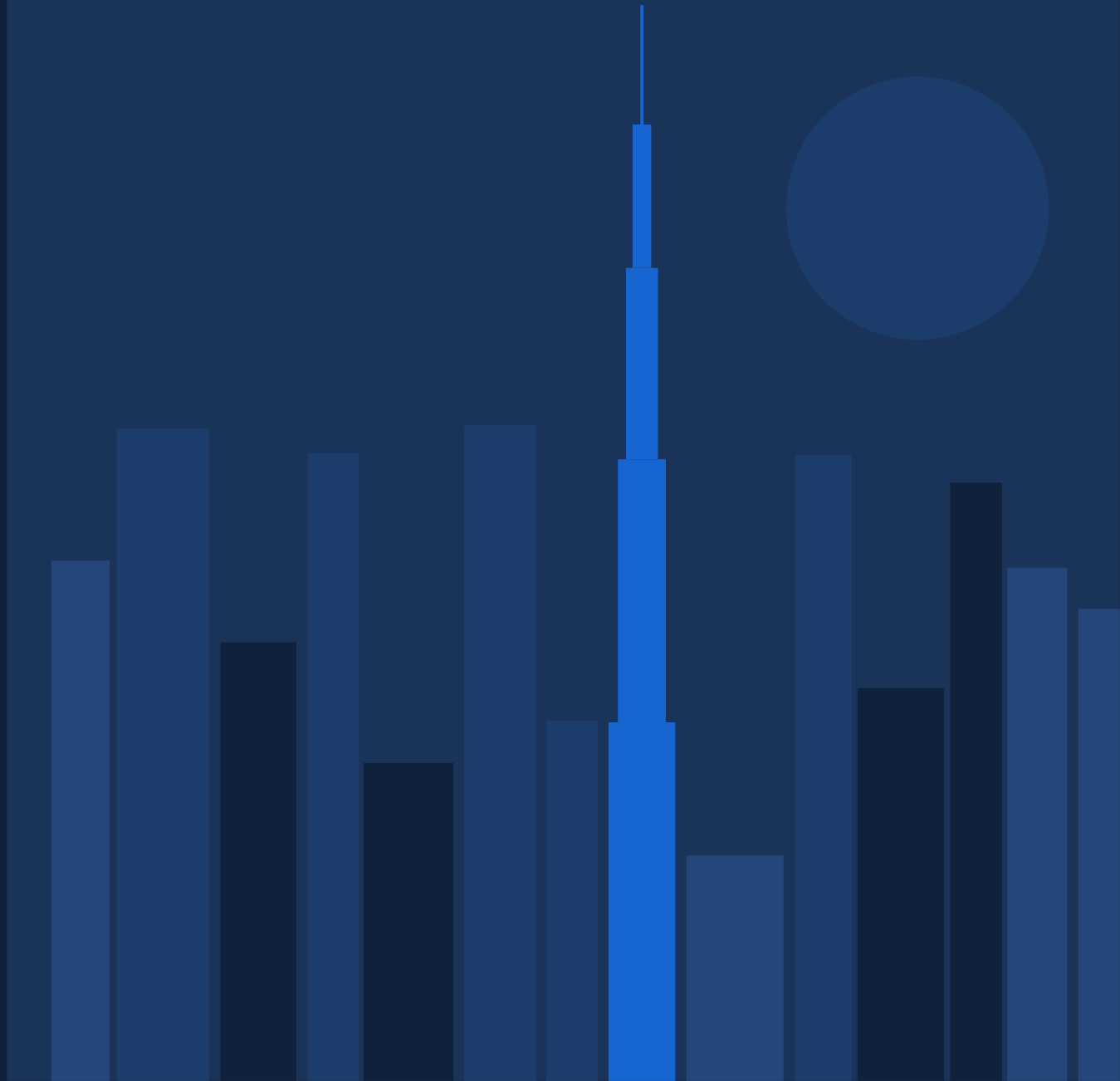
Community, selected resources, discovery and introductory activities — the open front door.

Fewer founders, deeper support, as you move up. Pricing, terms and eligibility will be shaped during the pilot — no fees or equity terms are fixed today.

UAE FIRST · GLOBAL AMBITION

Rooted in the UAE. Built to travel.

Startup Roof starts where policy, capital and founders are converging — and is designed to extend to other markets over time.



STARTUP ROOF

03

The founder journey

Six stages, practical checklists, key metrics and funding options

IN THIS CHAPTER

Six stages at a glance

Stage-by-stage checklists

Startup metrics explained

Funding options compared

How funding stages work

THE FOUNDER JOURNEY

Every founder enters at a different point.

	Explore	Validate	Build	Launch	Grow	Prepare for capital*
Founder question	**Is this idea worth pursuing?**	**Will people actually pay for this?**	**What is the simplest version to offer?**	**How do I reach my first customers?**	**How do I grow without breaking things?**	**Should I raise — and am I ready?**
Support needed	Framing, problem discovery, peer conversation	Interview guides, clinics, mentor feedback	Product, setup, legal and tool guidance	Go-to-market, pricing, brand and sales support	Operations, specialists, systems and hiring	Readiness review, pitch feedback, introductions
Useful next action	Write down the problem and who has it	Speak to 10–20 potential customers	Define a first offer and test it	Run one focused acquisition test	Fix the biggest bottleneck	Decide if external funding fits

Paths differ. Founders join at any stage and may loop back. *Many good businesses grow from revenue and never need external capital — this stage applies only where appropriate.

From idea to evidence.

STAGE 1 Explore

Decide whether an idea is worth testing.

KEY QUESTIONS

Whose problem is this, and how painful is it?

How do people solve it today?

Why am I the right person to solve it?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- [ ] Write a one-line problem statement
- [ ] Describe the target customer
- [ ] List current alternatives
- [ ] Note your unfair advantages
- [ ] Pick three assumptions to test

Sign of progress: A clear, testable problem statement
Startup Roof support: Peer groups, idea clinics, the Explore templates

STAGE 2 Validate

Prove that people want it — and will pay.

KEY QUESTIONS

Will people pay, and how much?

Who is the first, most eager customer?

What is the smallest test I can run?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- [ ] Run 10–20 customer conversations
- [ ] Test a price with a pre-order or deposit
- [ ] Build a landing page or sample
- [ ] Record what you learned
- [ ] Decide: continue, change or stop

Sign of progress: Customers committing time or money
Startup Roof support: Validation clinic, interview guide, mentor feedback

From first offer to first customers.

STAGE 3 Build

Create the simplest version people will pay for.

KEY QUESTIONS

What is the minimum viable product?

Which company structure and licence do I need?

What will it cost to deliver?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- [ ] Define the first offer and scope
- [ ] Choose setup route and licence
- [ ] Estimate unit costs and margin
- [ ] Set up basic finance and contracts
- [ ] Line up first customers

Sign of progress: A first offer delivered to real customers
Startup Roof support: Setup, legal and product specialists; templates

STAGE 4 Launch

Reach first customers in a repeatable way.

KEY QUESTIONS

Which channel brings customers most efficiently?

Is my pricing right?

What do customers say after buying?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- [ ] Pick one acquisition channel to test
- [ ] Track cost per customer
- [ ] Collect reviews and feedback
- [ ] Refine pricing and packaging
- [ ] Build a simple sales process

Sign of progress: Repeat sales from a known channel
Startup Roof support: GTM sessions, marketing and sales specialists

From traction to scale — and capital where it fits.

STAGE 5 Grow

Scale what works without breaking the business.

KEY QUESTIONS

Where is the biggest bottleneck?

Which roles or systems come next?

How do I protect cash while growing?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- [ ] Map the operating bottleneck
- [ ] Automate repeat tasks
- [ ] Plan first key hires
- [ ] Review margins by product or client
- [ ] Set a 12-month cash plan

Sign of progress: Growth with healthy margins and cash
Startup Roof support: Operations, automation, finance and hiring support

STAGE 6 Prepare for capital

Decide if external funding fits — and get ready.

KEY QUESTIONS

Do I need outside money, and why?

Which type of capital suits my business?

What will investors ask to see?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- [ ] Define what the money is for
- [ ] Compare funding options
- [ ] Prepare core metrics and data room
- [ ] Sharpen the pitch and story
- [ ] Practise with experienced investors

Sign of progress: A funding decision made on evidence
Startup Roof support: Readiness review, pitch feedback, relevant introductions

STARTUP METRICS, EXPLAINED SIMPLY

The numbers every founder should understand.

MVP

Minimum viable product

The simplest version that real customers will use or pay for.

PMF

Product–market fit

Customers keep buying and recommending without heavy pushing.

CAC

Customer acquisition cost

Sales + marketing spend ÷ new customers won.

LTV

Customer lifetime value

Average gross profit per customer over the relationship.

GM

Gross margin

(Revenue − direct costs) ÷ revenue.

Burn

Monthly net burn

Cash out − cash in, per month.

Runway

Months of cash left

Cash in the bank ÷ monthly net burn.

Churn

Customer churn

Customers lost in a period ÷ customers at the start.

Rule of thumb many investors use: LTV should comfortably exceed CAC — often cited as about 3×. Founder OS is planned to help track these simply.

FUNDING OPTIONS COMPARED

There is more than one way to fund a business.

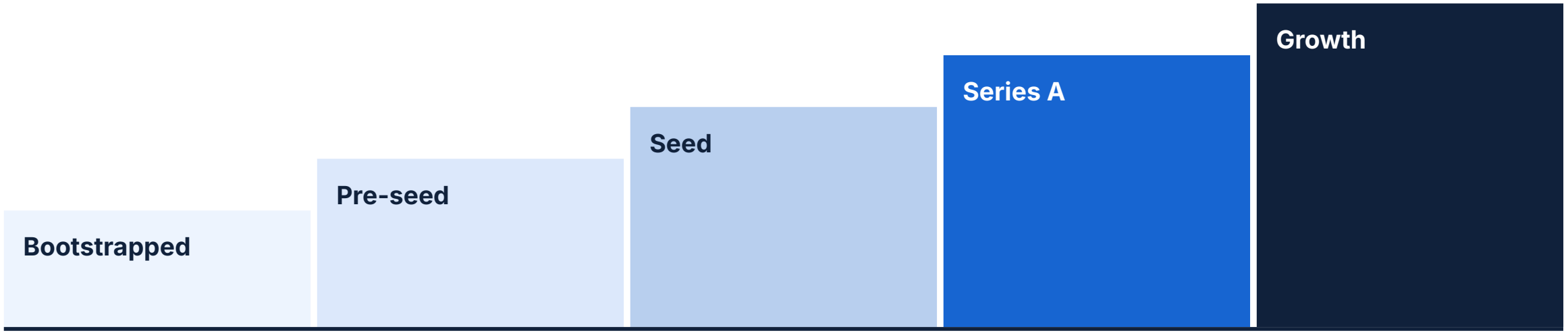
SOURCE	BEST SUITED TO	WHAT YOU GIVE UP	WATCH OUT FOR
Revenue and savings	Businesses that can sell early	Nothing — full control	Slower growth; personal risk
Friends and family	Very early tests	Sometimes equity	Relationships if it goes wrong
Grants and programmes	Innovation, sector or social goals	Time and reporting	Eligibility and timelines
Bank and SME finance	Proven revenue and assets	Repayments and collateral	Cash-flow pressure
Angel investors	Early teams with potential to scale	Equity	Fit, terms and expectations
Venture capital	Fast-growing, large-market ventures	Equity and some control	Pressure for rapid scale
Venture debt	VC-backed companies with revenue	Repayments and covenants	Usually needs equity investors first
Crowdfunding	Consumer products with a community	Rewards or equity	Campaign effort; public scrutiny

General guidance only — not financial advice. The right option depends on the business, its stage and the founder's goals.

HOW EQUITY FUNDING STAGES USUALLY WORK

Each round buys proof for the next step.

Bootstrapped	Pre-seed	Seed	Series A	Growth
USED TO	USED TO	USED TO	USED TO	USED TO
Own money and revenue	Test and build the first version	Find product–market fit	Build a repeatable growth engine	Scale into new markets
INVESTORS LOOK FOR	INVESTORS LOOK FOR	INVESTORS LOOK FOR	INVESTORS LOOK FOR	INVESTORS LOOK FOR
A real problem and early demand	Team, insight and first signals	Early traction and repeat usage	Proven model and strong metrics	Efficient, predictable growth



Stage names and expectations vary by market and sector. Many businesses never raise equity — and that can be the right choice.

04

Founder OS

The planned digital workspace, illustrative screens and principles

IN THIS CHAPTER

The digital workspace

Onboarding and the next-step engine

An illustrative scenario

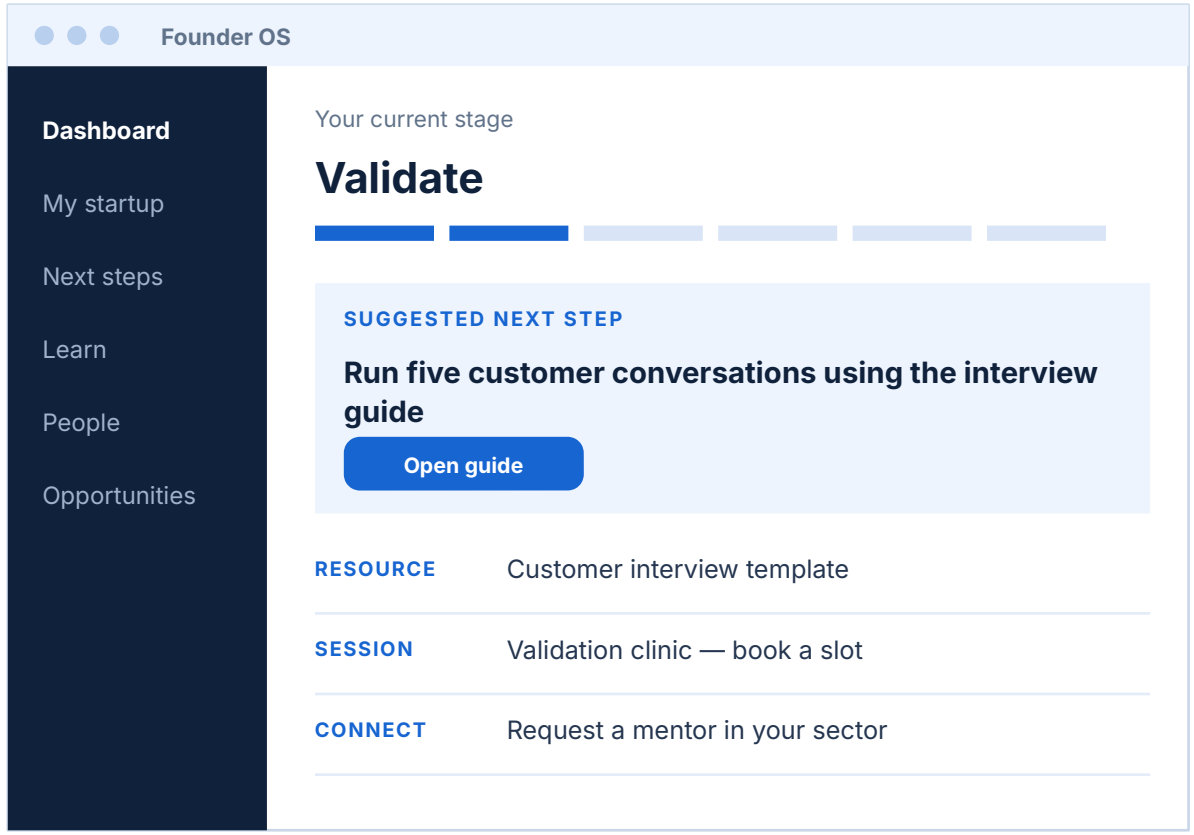
People, opportunities and services

Architecture and trust

What to build first

PLANNED CAPABILITY

A digital workspace for the founder journey.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

1 My startup

Founder profile · stage and goals · personal dashboard

2 Next steps

Tasks · resources and templates · learning progress

3 People and support

Mentor and specialist discovery · connection requests · service requests

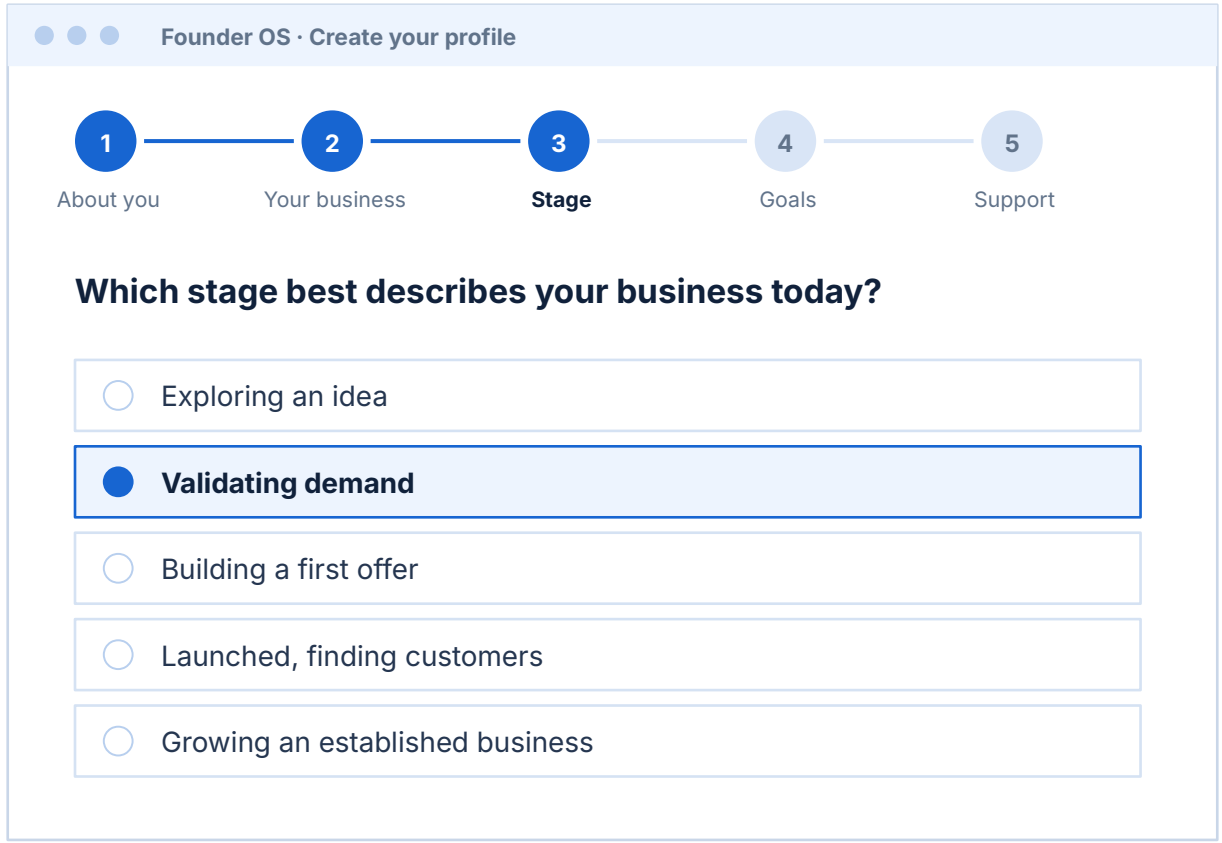
4 Opportunities and progress

Relevant opportunities · activity and progress tracking

Capabilities will be prioritised with pilot founders and released step by step.

PLANNED CAPABILITY

A five-minute profile that shapes everything after it.



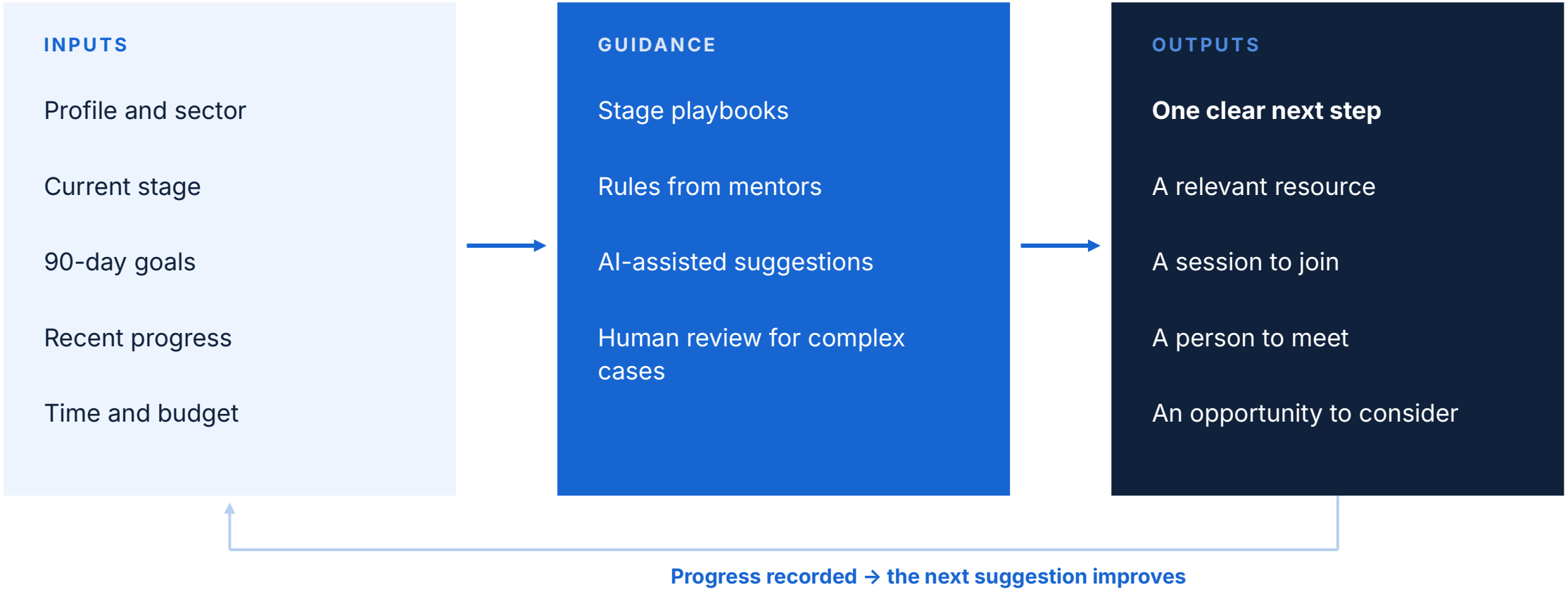
Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

WHAT THE PROFILE CAPTURES

Founder	Experience, skills, time available, location
Business	Sector, model, customers, team size
Stage	Explore, Validate, Build, Launch, Grow, Capital
Goals	What success looks like in the next 90 days
Support	Preferred formats and areas where help is needed
Visibility	What is shared, with whom — founder controls it

PLANNED CAPABILITY

How a founder’s next step is suggested.



ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

A founder joins with an idea and needs to validate demand.

THE SCENARIO

A first-time founder in Dubai wants to launch a healthy-snack brand. The recipe is ready and the enthusiasm is real, but there is no evidence yet that customers will buy.

This is an example of how the experience is designed to work — not a real customer case.

1

Complete a profile

Stage, sector, goals and time available.

2

Identify the challenge

“I don’t know if anyone will pay for this.”

3

Get a relevant next step

An interview guide and a short validation task.

4

Attend a clinic or ask for help

A group validation clinic or a mentor request.

5

Record progress

Notes from 12 conversations; pricing feedback logged.

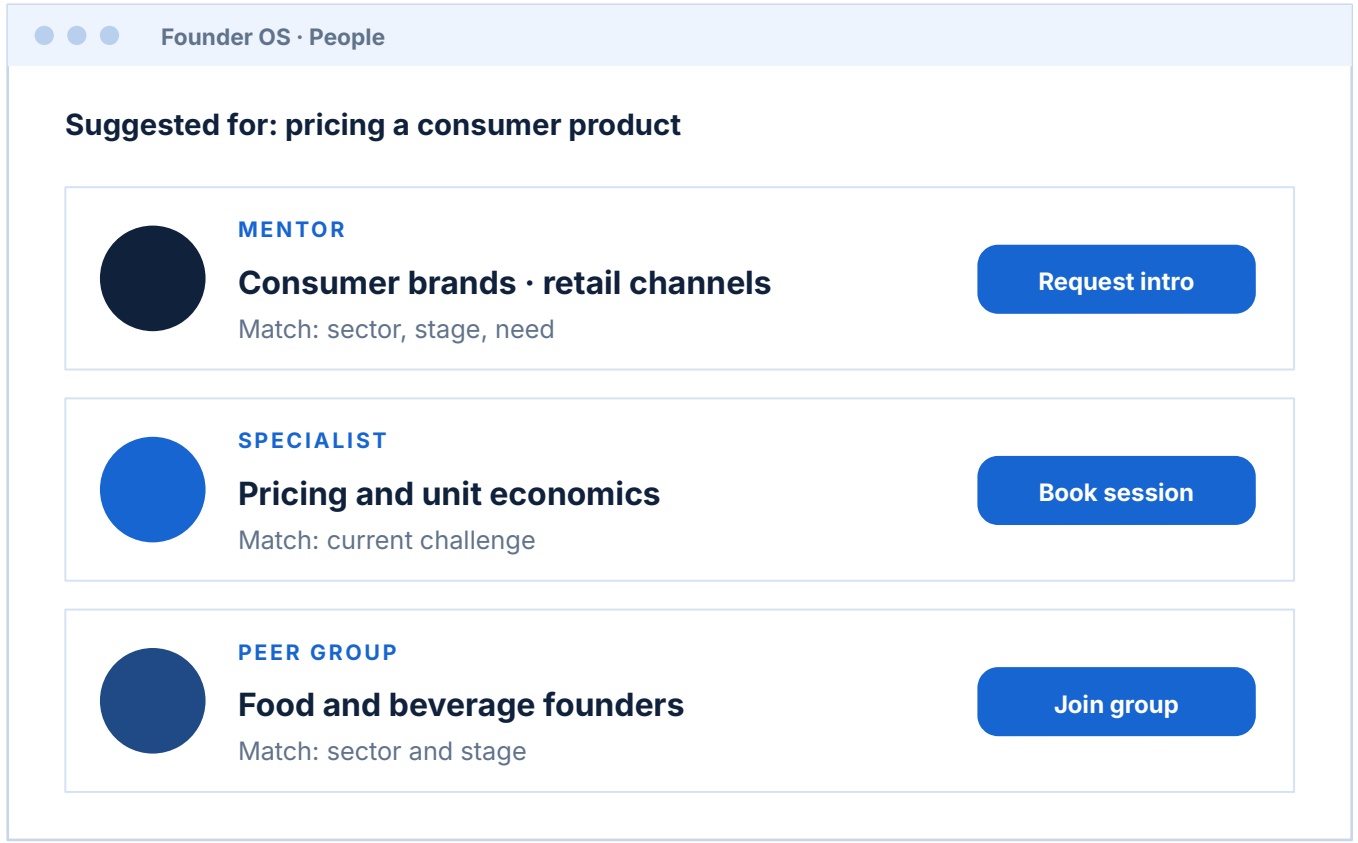
6

Return for the next step

Move on to testing a first offer.

PLANNED CAPABILITY

Matched by need, stage and sector — not by chance.



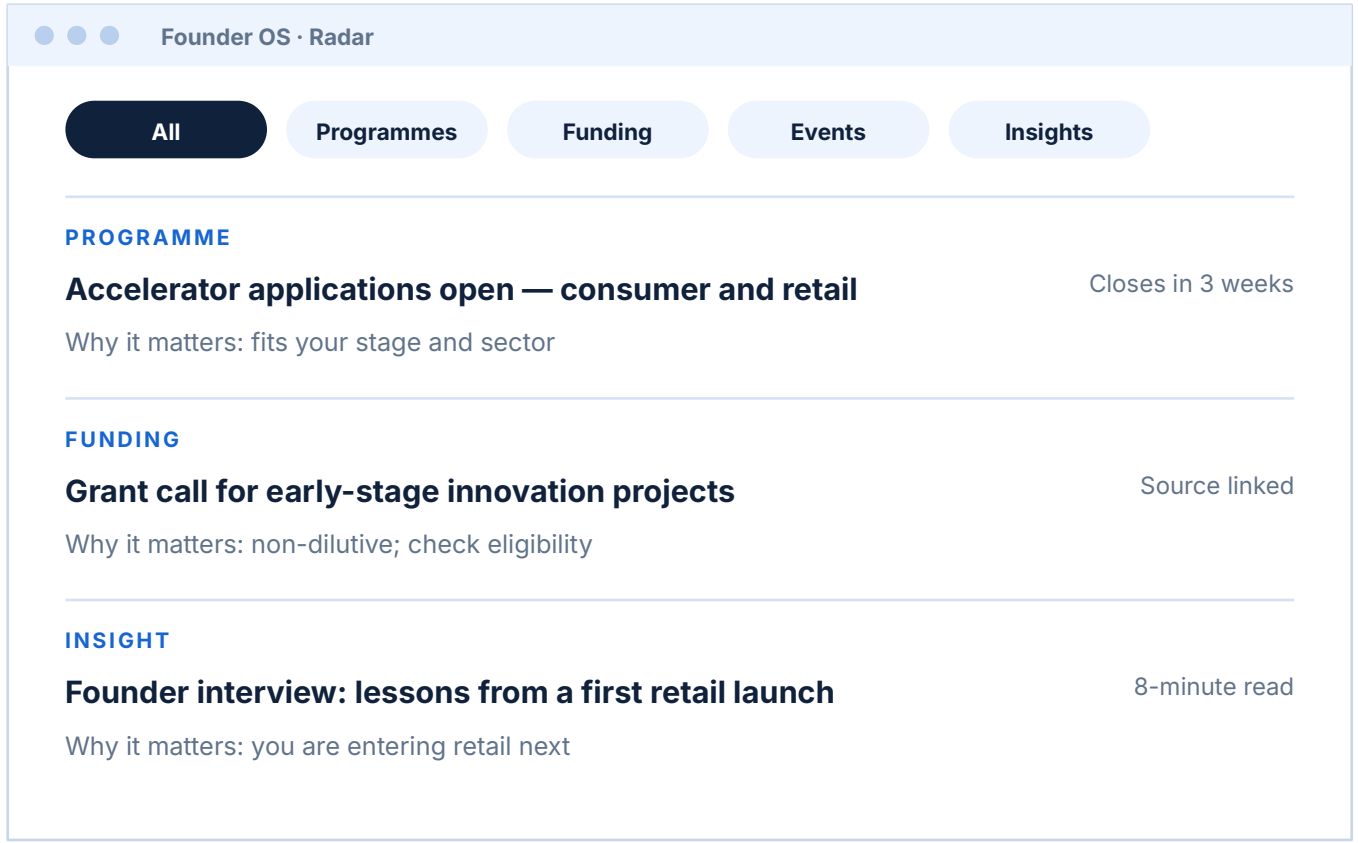
Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

MATCHING CRITERIA

Need	The founder's current challenge
Stage	Where the business is today
Sector	Relevant industry experience
Availability	Real time the expert can give
Consent	Both sides agree before an introduction

PLANNED CAPABILITY

Relevant opportunities, with context and a next step.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

EVERY ITEM SHOWS

Relevance	Why it fits this founder
Source	Credited and linked
Date	When it was published or closes
Next step	What to do about it

Sample items for illustration; they do not refer to real programmes.

PLANNED CAPABILITY

From “I need help” to a delivered, reviewed outcome.



Request	Scope	Match	Agree	Deliver	Review
Founder describes the need in plain words.	Need is clarified into a defined piece of work.	Suitable expert or partner is proposed.	Scope, timing and price confirmed up front.	Work done; progress visible to the founder.	Founder rates the outcome; quality is tracked.

QUALITY SAFEGUARDS UNDER TEST IN THE PILOT

Clear scope first

No open-ended engagements

Transparent pricing

Agreed before work starts

Vetted providers

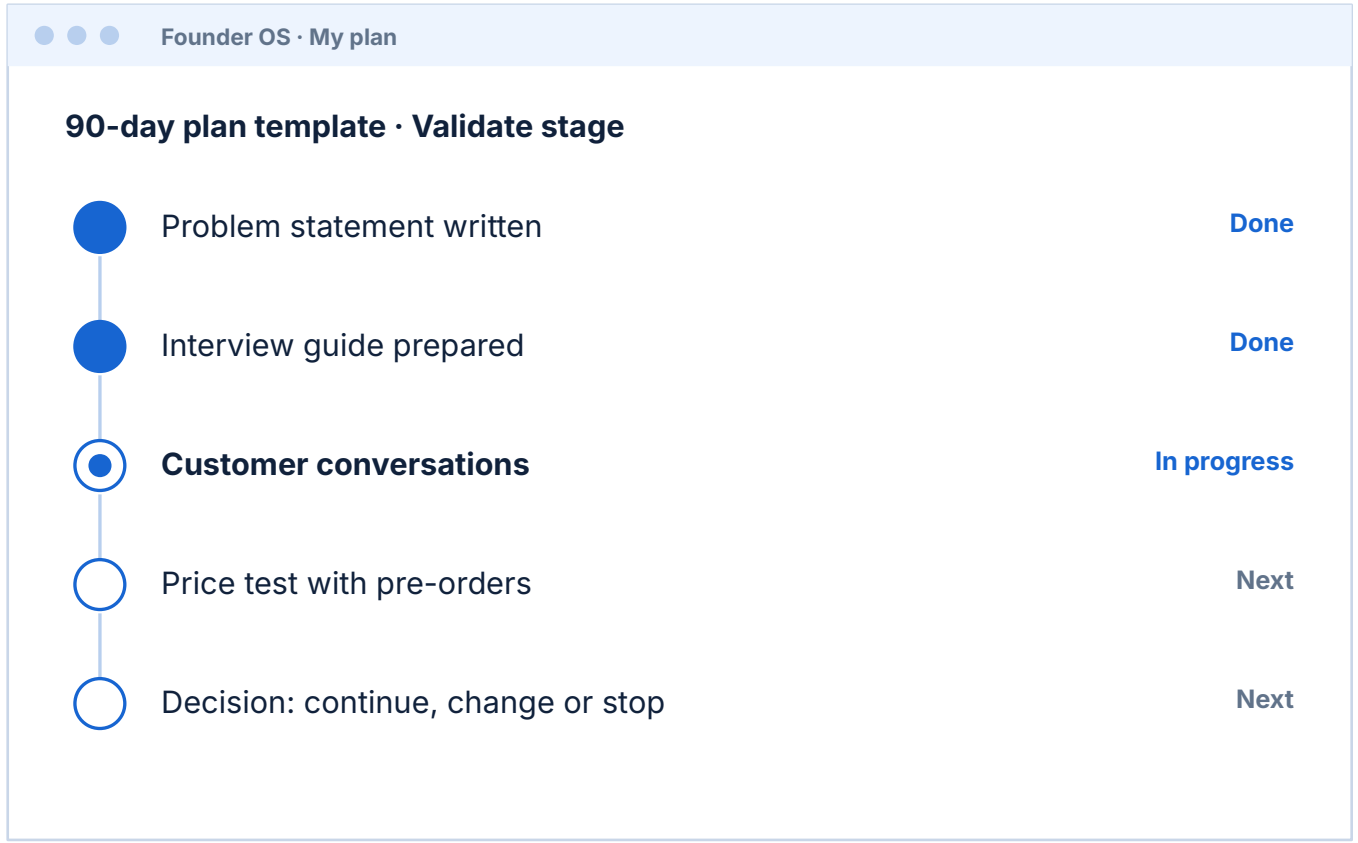
Selected on track record

Founder reviews

Visible quality over time

PLANNED CAPABILITY

A simple plan that shows how far you have come.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

WHY IT MATTERS

For founders

Momentum and a record of decisions made.

For mentors

Context before each conversation.

For readiness

Evidence to share — only with consent.

For Startup Roof

Measures whether support is useful.

PLANNED ARCHITECTURE

A simple, modular platform — built step by step.

EXPERIENCE	Web and mobile-friendly workspace · dashboard · notifications · community spaces
FOUNDER MODULES	Profile · next steps · resources · learning · people · opportunities · services · progress
GUIDANCE LAYER	Stage playbooks · mentor rules · AI-assisted drafting and suggestions · human escalation
DATA AND TRUST	Consent records · visibility settings · secure storage · audit of introductions
INTEGRATIONS	Calendar and video · email and messaging · payments · partner tools, where rights allow

Technology choices will be made after the pilot confirms which capabilities founders actually use.

TRUST, PRIVACY AND RESPONSIBLE AI

Principles we intend to build in from day one.

Consent first

No introduction or data sharing without the founder's agreement.

Founder-controlled visibility

Founders decide what their profile shows, and to whom.

Data minimisation

Collect only what improves the founder's support.

Transparent AI

AI-assisted content is labelled; founders can always ask a person.

Human escalation

Complex legal, financial or personal matters go to qualified people.

Secure by design

Access controls, encryption and audit trails as standard practice.

Founder OS will be designed with the UAE Personal Data Protection Law (Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021) and the rules of any other market it enters in mind; formal legal review will precede launch.

Start small, learn fast, then add depth.

MUST HAVE Pilot	SHOULD HAVE After pilot	COULD HAVE Once proven	LATER Separate decisions
Founder profile and stage	Mentor and specialist discovery	AI-assisted drafting and planning	Investor-readiness profiles
Next-step suggestions	Opportunities feed (Radar)	Partner tool integrations	Payments and marketplace
Resource and template library	Peer groups and discussions	Learning paths with progress	Multi-market localisation
Session booking and requests	Service request workflow	Mobile app experience	Advanced analytics
Basic progress tracking			

Prioritisation will be confirmed with pilot founders; items may move between columns.

05

Ecosystem services

Community, mentoring, Academy, expert services, insights and incubation

IN THIS CHAPTER

AI with human support

Community and a year-round rhythm

Mentoring

Founder Academy

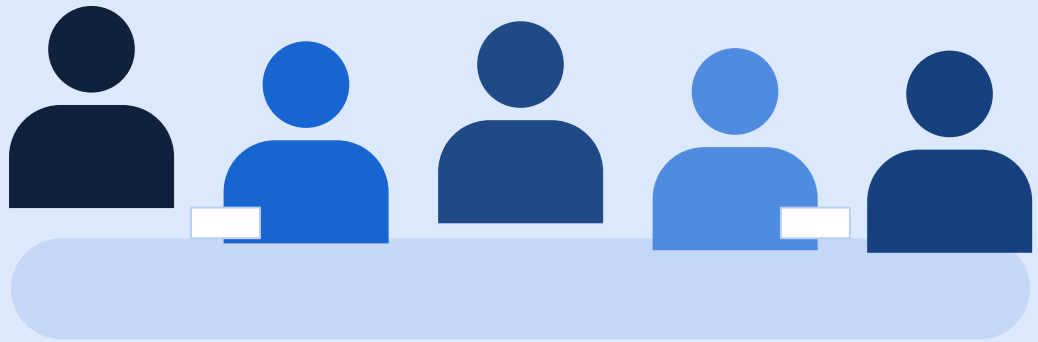
Expert services

Insights, incubation and readiness

COMMUNITY

Founders do better together.

Peer groups, office hours and small gatherings turn a lonely journey into a shared one — with accountability built in.



STARTUP ROOF

PROPOSED APPROACH

Digital guidance, strengthened by human experience.

AI-ASSISTED SUPPORT

Helps founders prepare and keep momentum

- Organising information
- Exploring questions
- Drafting plans
- Suggesting resources
- Tracking next steps

The founder decides

HUMAN SUPPORT

Brings judgement and real-world context

- Mentoring
- Specialist judgement
- Practical feedback
- Complex business decisions
- Sector expertise

Principle: AI prepares, people judge, founders decide. AI features will be tested with pilot founders before release; none is presented here as live.

COMMUNITY AND MEANINGFUL CONNECTIONS

Relevant connections, measured by what happens next.



How a useful connection is designed to work — each introduction is opt-in on both sides and followed up.

WAYS PEOPLE MAY CONNECT

Founder introductions
matched by need, stage or sector

Office hours
short, bookable time with experts

Small gatherings
in-person meetups in the UAE

Accountability
check-ins on commitments made

Peer groups
small cohorts facing similar problems

Mentor sessions
focused conversations with follow-up

Community discussions
questions answered by peers

PRODUCT PRINCIPLES

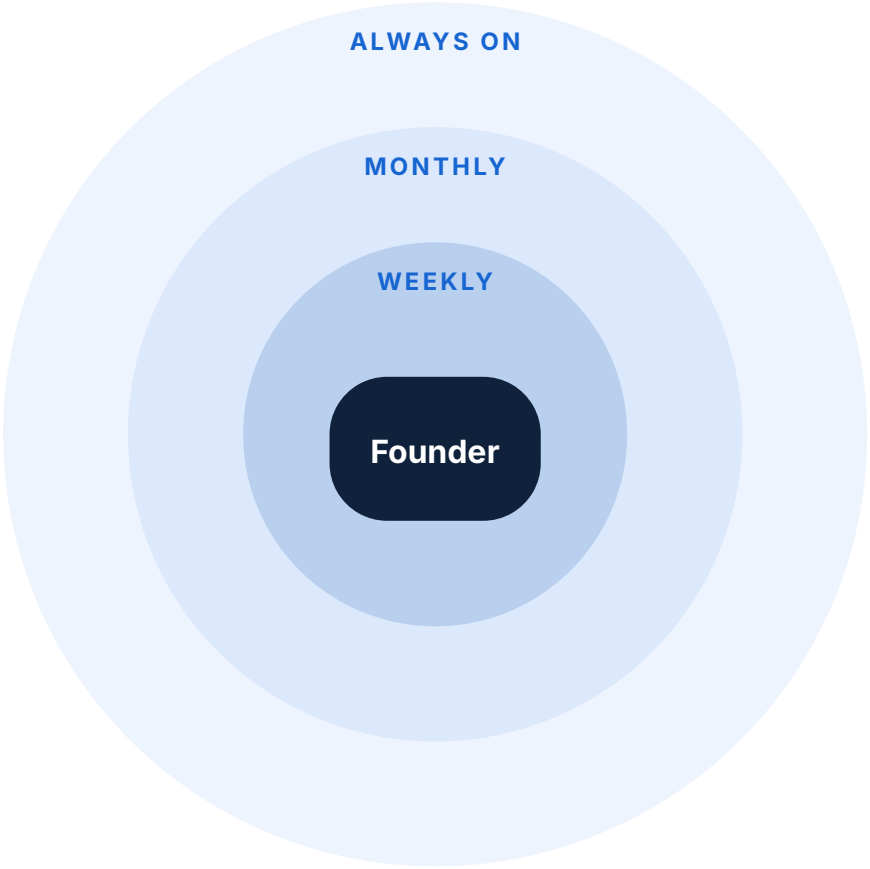
Consent first
No introduction without agreement from both sides.

Founder-controlled visibility
Founders choose what their profile shows, and to whom.

Quality over size
We track completed, useful interactions — not directory size.

PROPOSED RHYTHM

Support that does not stop when a programme ends.



Weekly

Office hours · peer-group check-ins · new resources and opportunities in Founder OS

Monthly

Thematic clinics · Academy sessions · mentor rounds · small founder gatherings

Quarterly

Progress reviews · showcase sessions · partner workshops · cohort intakes

Always on

Founder OS workspace · community discussions · service requests · Radar insights

Formats and frequency will be set by founder demand and delivery capacity.

PROPOSED MODEL

Focused conversations with follow-through.



Prepare

Founder states the question and shares context in Founder OS.

Match

A mentor with relevant experience accepts the request.

Meet

30–60 minutes focused on one decision or problem.

Commit

Founder records one or two concrete actions.

Follow up

Check-in on progress; next session only if useful.

MENTORS COMMIT TO

- **Honest, practical feedback**
- **Declaring any conflicts of interest**
- **Respecting confidentiality**
- **Agreed availability, not open-ended time**

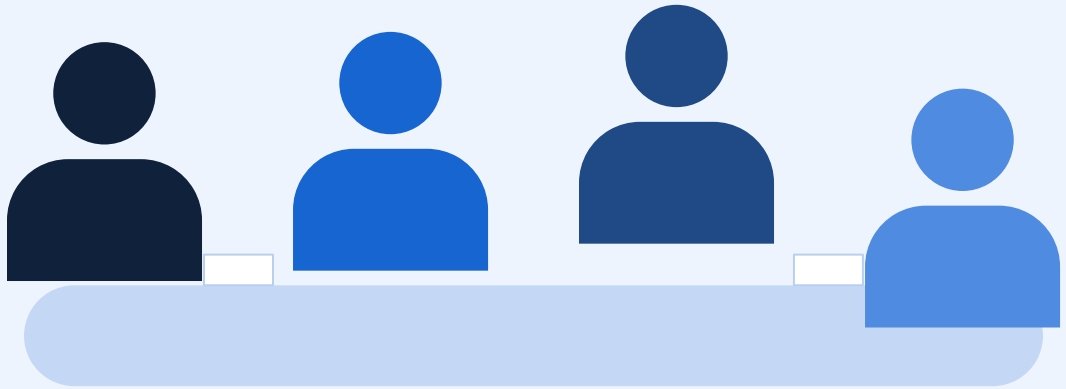
FOUNDERS COMMIT TO

- **Preparing a clear question**
- **Respecting the mentor's time**
- **Acting on what was agreed**
- **Sharing progress and feedback**

FOUNDER ACADEMY

Learn it on Monday. Use it on Tuesday.

Short, practical sessions where every founder leaves with a task to apply to their own business.



STARTUP ROOF

Practical learning that ends in action.

01 **Idea validation**

02 **Business models**

03 **AI and automation**

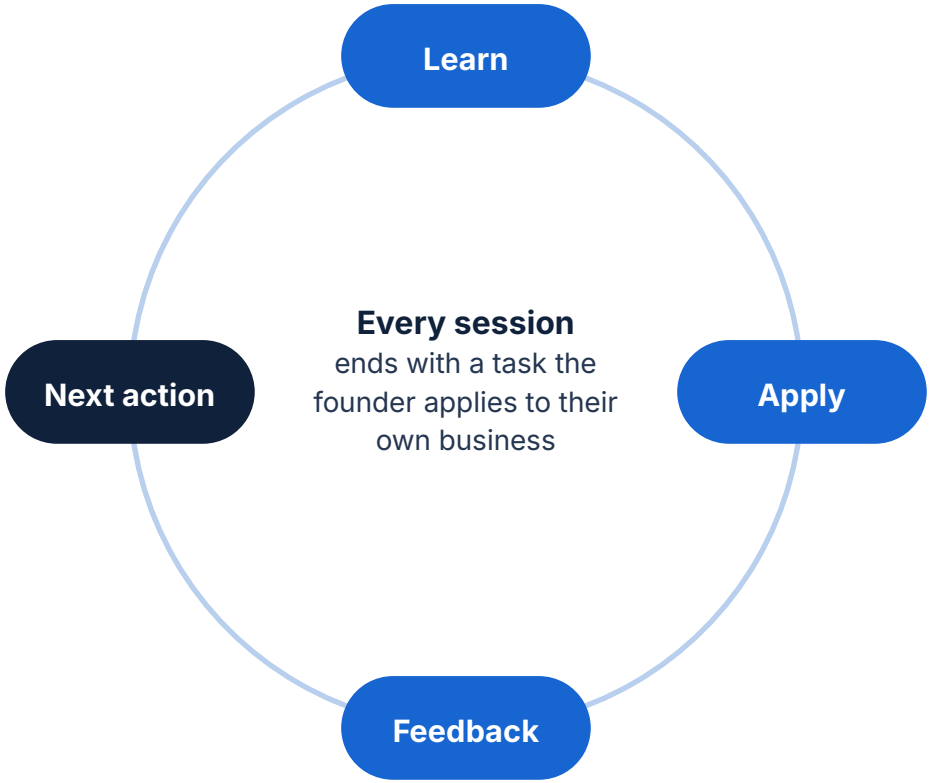
04 **Go-to-market and customer acquisition**

05 **Pricing and unit economics**

06 **Pitch readiness**

07 **Legal and operational foundations**

08 **Consumer-brand and retail development**



Themes are a starting point; sessions and depth will be shaped with founders and contributors during the pilot.

Eight themes, each ending in a practical output.

THEME	EXAMPLE SESSION	FOUNDER LEAVES WITH
Idea validation	Running customer interviews that reveal the truth	An interview guide and a list of 10 people to call
Business models	How your business actually makes money	A one-page business model
AI and automation	Practical AI tools for a small team	Three tasks automated or AI-assisted
GTM and customer acquisition	Choosing your first channel	A 30-day acquisition test plan
Pricing and unit economics	Pricing with confidence; knowing your margin	A pricing sheet and unit-cost model
Pitch readiness	Telling the story investors and partners need	A 10-slide outline and practice feedback
Legal and operational foundations	Setup routes, contracts and compliance basics	A setup checklist and key contract list
Consumer-brand and retail development	From product to shelf or online store	A channel plan and retailer pitch

EXPERT SERVICES AND PARTNER TOOLS

The right specialist or tool, at the right moment.

POTENTIAL SERVICE CATEGORIES

- **Legal**
- **Accounting and finance**
- **Branding and design**
- **Technology and automation**
- **Marketing and sales**
- **Customer communication**
- **Business setup**
- **Product and retail guidance**

THREE POSSIBLE DELIVERY ROUTES

Expert sessions

Short clinics and one-to-one sessions with experienced practitioners.

Partner-provided services

Defined packages from vetted providers, with clear scope before work starts.

Integrated or white-label tools

Useful software inside Founder OS, where commercial rights allow.

Packages, providers, integrations and fulfilment will be validated during the pilot. No supplier is presented here as a confirmed partner.

Common requests by category.

Legal

Company setup documents, shareholder agreements, contracts, IP basics

Branding and design

Name and identity, packaging, pitch design, website look and feel

Marketing and sales

Positioning, social and paid campaigns, sales scripts and CRM

Business setup

Licence route, free zone or mainland choice, banking and visas

Accounting and finance

Bookkeeping, VAT registration, financial models, cash-flow planning

Technology and automation

No-code builds, website and app scoping, workflow automation

Customer communication

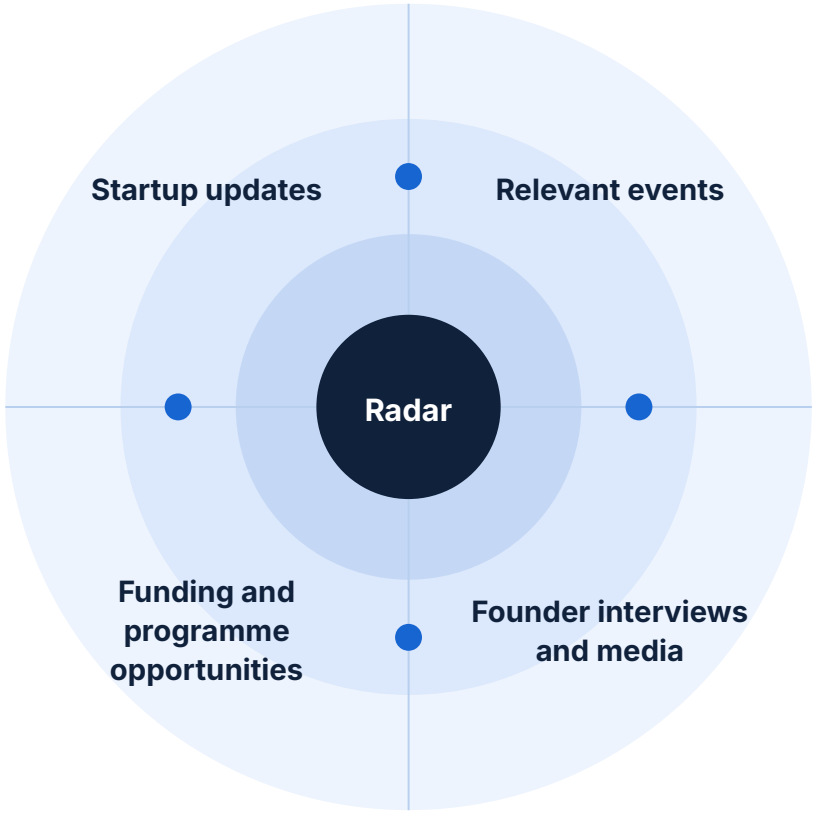
WhatsApp and email journeys, support processes, reviews

Product and retail guidance

Sourcing, manufacturing, listings, retail and marketplace entry

Examples of founder needs. Providers, packages and prices will be validated in the pilot; no supplier is confirmed.

What matters to a founder this week — with context.



Startup Roof Radar

A planned, curated view of updates, events and opportunities — starting with the UAE and widening over time.

Relevance	Filtered by a founder's stage, sector and location.
Attribution	Every item credits and links to its original source.
Freshness	Dated, and removed when no longer current.
Founder context	A short note on why it matters and what to do next.

Coverage will be selective and grow step by step; it is not intended to be a complete news service.

Selective, structured support where it can make a difference.

1. **Understand the founder's needs**
2. **Assess suitability**
3. **Define a practical support plan**
4. **Match mentors and specialists**
5. **Agree milestones**
6. **Review progress**

Selection point

EXAMPLE SUPPORT PLANS

	Technology startup	Consumer or service business
Typical focus	Product–market fit, early traction, technical choices	Unit economics, channels, supply and operations
Example milestone	First ten paying customers on a defined plan	Margin-positive pilot with one retail or online channel
Typical specialists	Product, AI/automation, go-to-market	Brand, retail, sourcing, finance

Intensive support is selective.

Places depend on fit, the founder's commitment and our delivery capacity. Terms are agreed separately with each business.

INVESTOR READINESS CHECKLIST

What founders should have in place before raising.

BUSINESS	MODEL	TEAM	FINANCE	LEGAL
☐ A clear problem and target customer	☐ Unit economics you understand	☐ The right founding team and gaps known	☐ Up-to-date accounts and runway	☐ Clean company and share structure
☐ Evidence of demand or traction	☐ A credible plan for the funds	☐ Advisers or mentors where useful	☐ A simple financial model	☐ IP and key contracts in order

How Startup Roof helps: readiness reviews, pitch feedback, data-room templates and — where relevant and with consent — introductions to investors who match the founder's sector and stage.

06

Value for the ecosystem

Investors, universities, corporates and service partners

IN THIS CHAPTER

Investors

Ecosystem partners

Universities and incubators

Corporates and service providers

VALUE FOR INVESTORS

Better-prepared founders. More useful conversations.

- **Better founder preparation**
  Founders work through readiness before an introduction.
- **More structured information**
  Consistent profiles, stage and progress — shared with consent.
- **Relevant discovery**
  Filter by sector, stage and geography.
- **Sector-specific engagement**
  Join sessions in areas you know well.
- **More useful introductions**
  Fewer, better-matched conversations.
- **Ongoing ecosystem relationships**
  Stay close to founders and mentors over time.

STARTUP ROOF AIMS TO	STARTUP ROOF DOES NOT
Help founders become investor-ready	Operate its own investment fund today
Make relevant, consented introductions	Promise deal flow, exclusivity or returns
Share structured founder information	Recommend or endorse specific investments
Host sector sessions with investors	Assume every founder should raise capital

Any future investment activity would require its own structure, approvals and terms.

Collaborations that are useful to founders and to partners.

WHY PARTNERS MAY TAKE PART

01 **Reach relevant founders**

02 **Deliver education or specialist support**

03 **Test useful services**

04 **Build long-term relationships**

05 **Support entrepreneurship programmes**

06 **Explore commercial distribution**

COLLABORATION FORMAT	SUITS	WHAT IT COULD LOOK LIKE
Workshops	Specialists, firms	A practical 90-minute session on a founder topic
Office hours	Mentors, advisers	Regular bookable slots with short follow-up
University programmes	Universities, incubators	Support for student and alumni founders
Tool or service pilots	Technology and service providers	A limited trial with feedback from founders
Community activities	Corporates, venues	Hosting a meetup or a themed founder evening
Content collaboration	Media, experts	Guides, interviews or co-created resources

These are possible formats to explore together; no partnerships are presented here as signed.

UNIVERSITIES AND INCUBATORS

Continuity for student and alumni founders.

Idea in class	Programme	Startup Roof	Alumni founder
Course project, club or competition	University incubator or challenge	Year-round guidance, mentors and tools	Growth support and community

WHAT UNIVERSITIES COULD GAIN

Support for founders after programmes end

Practitioner mentors and specialists

Visibility for student ventures

Practical content for entrepreneurship courses

POSSIBLE COLLABORATION FORMATS

Guest clinics and workshops

Joint founder challenges

Mentor office hours on campus

Access to Founder OS for student founders

Practical ways to work with early-stage founders.

PARTNER TYPE	WHAT THEY CAN OFFER	WHAT THEY CAN GAIN	STARTING FORMAT
Corporate innovation teams	Challenges, pilots, expertise, mentors	Early access to new solutions and talent	A themed founder challenge
Professional firms	Legal, finance, tax and setup advice	Relationships with future clients	Monthly office hours
Technology providers	Tools, credits, technical guidance	Adoption by relevant founders	A limited tool pilot
Banks and financial institutions	SME banking, finance education	Better-prepared SME customers	A founder finance clinic
Venues and co-working spaces	Space for sessions and gatherings	Community activity and visibility	Hosting a founder evening
Media and content partners	Reach, interviews, editorial expertise	Founder stories and insights	A co-created guide or series

Illustrative formats for discussion. No partnerships are signed or implied.

07

Model, pilot and roadmap

Commercial hypotheses, pilot design, measurement, milestones and risks

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Commercial model
- Revenue hypotheses by phase
- Service economics
- Pilot design and measurement
- Roadmap and milestones
- Risks

A SUSTAINABLE COMMERCIAL MODEL

Free access can create reach. Useful services must create sustainable value.

Free access

Community, resources and discovery build reach and trust.

Optional paid value

Founders and partners pay only for what is clearly useful.

Delivery costs

Expert time, platform, events and support all have real costs.

Unit economics

To validate: each service must cover its costs and contribute to the whole.

REVENUE HYPOTHESES TO TEST

- Paid memberships or tools
- Specialist support packages
- Structured programmes
- Partner and service revenue arrangements
- Corporate or university programmes
- Sponsorship of suitable activities
- Selective incubation arrangements, where separately agreed

No financial forecast is presented. Pricing and margins will be tested in the pilot before any are published.

What we expect to explore, test and scale — and when.

	NOW · SHAPE	NEXT · PILOT	THEN · EXPAND
Paid memberships or tools	Explore	Test	Scale
Specialist support packages	Explore	Test	Scale
Structured programmes	Explore	Test	Scale
Partner and service revenue arrangements	Explore	Explore	Test
Corporate or university programmes	Explore	Test	Test
Sponsorship of suitable activities	—	Explore	Test
Selective incubation arrangements	—	Explore	Test

Sequencing is a working hypothesis and will change with pilot evidence. “Scale” means only after unit economics are proven.

HOW EACH SERVICE MUST PAY ITS WAY

A simple test for every paid offer.

Price paid
by founder or partner

−

Delivery cost
expert time, materials, venue

−

Platform cost
share of tools, support, admin

=

Contribution
what is left to sustain the ecosystem

QUESTIONS THE PILOT MUST ANSWER

- What will founders pay for, and how much?
- How much expert time does each outcome really take?
- Which services can be delivered in groups to lower cost?
- Where do partners fund value for founders?
- What does free access cost per active founder?
- Which offers lead to repeat use?

PILOT DESIGN

PROPOSED

A small, measured test of the founder experience.

Who	A small group of founders across stages and sectors, including non-tech businesses.
What	Onboarding, a validation or growth track, clinics, mentor sessions and follow-up.
How	Simple tools first; Founder OS features introduced as they are ready.
Contributors	Participants deliver sessions and support in roles that suit their time and skills.
Learning	Founder interviews, feedback after every session, delivery cost tracked throughout.

THE PILOT SUCCEEDS IF

- **Founders complete useful next steps**
- **They come back without being chased**
- **Sessions are rated as practical**
- **Contributors can deliver reliably**
- **We know the real cost to serve**

HOW WE WILL MEASURE PROGRESS

One north-star measure, supported by a few honest indicators.

NORTH-STAR MEASURE

Completed founder next steps

A next step counts when the founder confirms it is done — a test run, a decision made, a customer won. It measures usefulness, not activity.

Activation

New founders who complete a profile and a first step

Follow-through

Agreed actions completed after sessions

Return rate

Founders active again within 30 days

Useful introductions

Introductions leading to a real conversation

Session quality

Founder rating of practical value

Cost to serve

Delivery cost per active founder

Paid conversion

Founders choosing an optional paid service

Contributor reliability

Sessions delivered as committed

TRIAL, VALIDATION AND ROADMAP

Shape, test, then expand what works.

NOW Shape and test

- Founder interviews
- Participant contributions
- Service selection
- Platform requirements

NEXT Deliver a small pilot

- Useful sessions
- Onboarding and follow-up
- Growth experiments
- Measure delivery costs

THEN Expand what works

- Repeat strong services
- Improve the platform
- Formalise responsibilities
- Build partnerships

MILESTONES WE ARE WORKING TOWARDS

10,000 free users

Threshold for a public launch event

March 2027 tentative

Target timing, subject to readiness

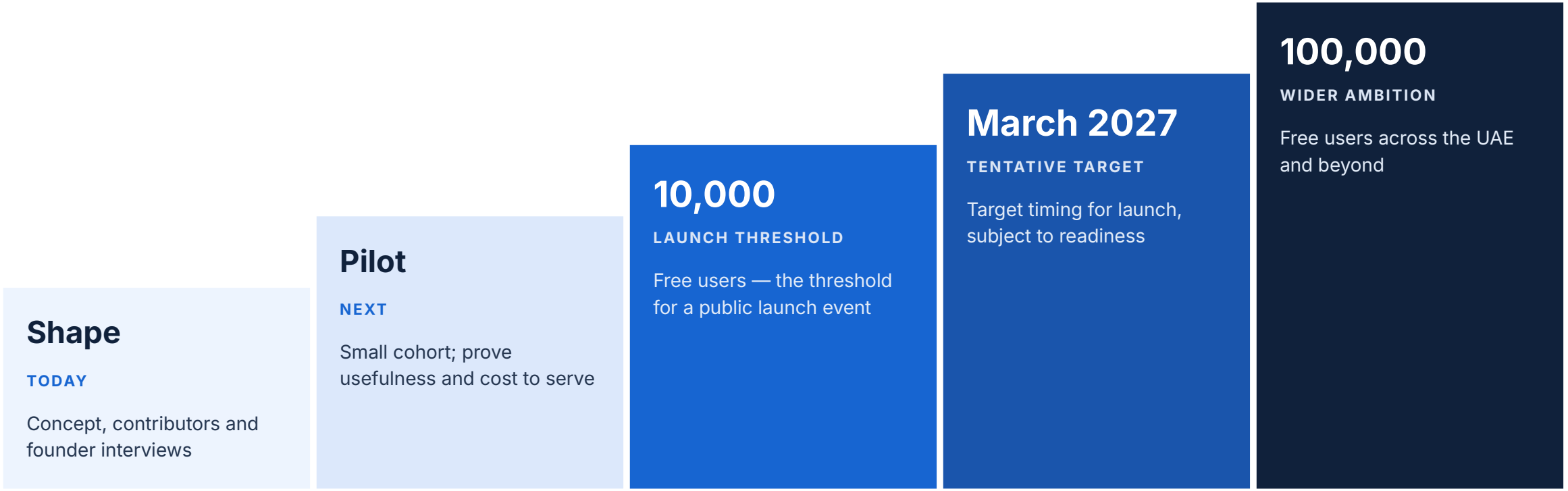
100,000 free users

Wider, longer-term ambition

Targets and timing will be refined through the pilot. These are ambitions, not current traction.

TARGETS, NOT TRACTION

Each step must be earned by the one before it.



All figures are targets to be refined through the pilot. None represents current users or traction.

RISKS AND HOW WE ADDRESS THEM

Being honest about what could go wrong.

RISK	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW WE ADDRESS IT
Low founder engagement	Without use, there is no ecosystem	Small pilot, practical formats, measure return rate
Inconsistent delivery	Volunteer time can be unreliable	Clear commitments; roles based on reliable delivery
Quality of advice	Poor advice harms founders and trust	Vetted contributors, founder ratings, human escalation
Cost to serve too high	Free access must be sustainable	Group formats, unit-economics test for every service
Platform built too early	Wasted effort on unused features	Simple tools first; build what the pilot proves
Data and privacy	Founder trust is essential	Consent-first design; UAE data-protection law review
Over-promising	Credibility with founders and partners	Clear stage labels; no claims beyond evidence

08

People and participation

Capabilities, contribution, FAQ, glossary and invitation

IN THIS CHAPTER

Capabilities

Ways to contribute

FAQ and glossary

Sources

Invitation to participate

Bringing complementary experience together.

STRATEGY AND COMMERCIAL

- Commercial leadership
- GTM and customer lifecycle
- Legal and governance

FOUNDER SUPPORT

- Startup and incubation experience
- Consumer-business mentoring
- Education and university outreach

PLATFORM AND GROWTH

- AI and business systems
- Branding and growth

COMMUNITY AND DELIVERY

- Operations and community
- Events and experiences

We are exploring how like-minded contributors can participate through their experience, resources and available time.

HOW ROLES WILL TAKE SHAPE

Longer-term roles and responsibilities will be considered as the project develops, based on contribution, time commitment, responsibility taken, reliable delivery and value created.

Ritesh Kumar
Project Initiator

WAYS TO CONTRIBUTE

Many roles, matched to experience and available time.

Session lead

Run a clinic, workshop or Academy session

Mentor

Give focused time to founders in your field

Workstream contributor

Help build part of the project — platform, content, partnerships

Specialist

Offer defined professional services

Connector

Introduce relevant organisations and people

Content contributor

Write guides, record interviews, share lessons

HOW LONGER-TERM ROLES WILL BE CONSIDERED

01 **Actual contribution**

02 **Time commitment**

03 **Responsibility taken**

04 **Reliable delivery**

05 **Value created**

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Short answers to common questions.

Is Startup Roof an accelerator or a fund?

Neither today. It is a founder ecosystem with a planned digital workspace. Any investment activity would need its own structure.

Do I need a tech startup to join?

No. Consumer, wellness, retail and service businesses are equally welcome.

Do I have to raise investment?

No. Many businesses grow from revenue; capital is one option among several.

How is my data used?

Consent first: founders control what is shared, and introductions need agreement from both sides.

Is Founder OS live?

Not yet. It is planned and will be introduced step by step, starting in the pilot.

Will it cost money?

Founder access starts free. Optional paid tools and services will be tested in the pilot.

Is it only for the UAE?

It starts in the UAE, with an ambition to extend to other markets.

How can I get involved?

Visit startuproof.com to express interest as a founder, mentor, partner, investor or contributor.

GLOSSARY

Startup terms used in this presentation.

Accelerator	A time-bound programme supporting startups, often with investment.
Angel investor	An individual who invests personal money in early startups.
Bootstrapping	Funding a business from savings and revenue.
CAC	Cost of acquiring one new customer.
Churn	The rate at which customers stop buying.
Dilution	Owning a smaller share after new shares are issued.
Free zone	A UAE economic zone with its own licensing rules.
GTM	Go-to-market: how a product reaches customers.
Incubator	Support for very early ventures, often with space and mentoring.
LTV	Gross profit expected from a customer over time.
MVP	Minimum viable product — the simplest sellable version.
Pre-seed / Seed	Early funding rounds to build and find product–market fit.
Product–market fit	Strong, repeat demand from a clear market.
Runway	Months a business can operate on current cash.
Unit economics	Revenue and cost per unit, customer or order.
Venture capital	Professional investment funds for high-growth companies.

SOURCES AND NOTES

External data used in this presentation.

1 CB Insights, “The Top 12 Reasons Startups Fail” (2021) — analysis of 111 startup post-mortems.

2 US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Business Employment Dynamics establishment survival data; “The Economics Daily”, 2024 (2013 cohort).

3 Calvino, F., Criscuolo, C. & Menon, C. (2015), “Cross-country evidence on start-up dynamics”, OECD STI Policy Papers.

4 Endeavor Insight (2015), research on New York City tech founders; “The Power of Entrepreneur Networks”.

5 Hallen, B., Cohen, S. & Bingham, C. (2020), “Do Accelerators Work? If So, How?”, Organization Science 31(2).

6 Wamda, annual MENA startup investment reviews, 2020–2025 (figures include debt financing).

7 Global Entrepreneurship Monitor: 2025/2026 Global Report (NECI ranking) and UAE country profile, 2025.

8 UAE Ministry of Economy; Central Bank of the UAE (SME share of non-oil GDP and of companies); Minister of Economy statement on SME numbers (2023).

9 Dubai Media Office, launch of the Dubai Economic Agenda D33 (January 2023).

10 UAE Ministry of Economy, “The Entrepreneurial Nation” initiative.

11 Startup Genome, Global Startup Ecosystem Report 2025.

12 OECD (2025), “Generative AI and the SME Workforce”; US Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey.

Figures are reported as published by each source and year. Startup Roof’s own targets are ambitions, not results.

INVITATION TO PARTICIPATE

Help shape a practical ecosystem for the founder journey.

Founders	Help shape the platform and express interest in the pilot.
Mentors and specialists	Contribute expertise and practical sessions.
Partners and universities	Explore a useful collaboration.
Investors	Connect around founder readiness and ecosystem opportunities.
Prospective collaborators	Discuss how your skills and time can contribute.

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